



1564-1616 WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

English author Shakespeare was born and died in Stratford-upon-Avon but spent his creative years in London. Between 1589 and 1613 he wrote 38 plays and 154 sonnets, works that have made him world-famous.

1599 SHAKESPEARE AT THE GLOBE

The Globe theatre was built in London alongside the Thames to house The Lord Chamberlain's Men, a company of actors that included William Shakespeare. His *Henry V* was probably the first play performed there in 1599. Appealing both to the literate elite and the common people, London theatres were at the hub of a vigorous cultural scene that has been called the English Renaissance.



△ Shakespeare's Globe, from a UK stamp

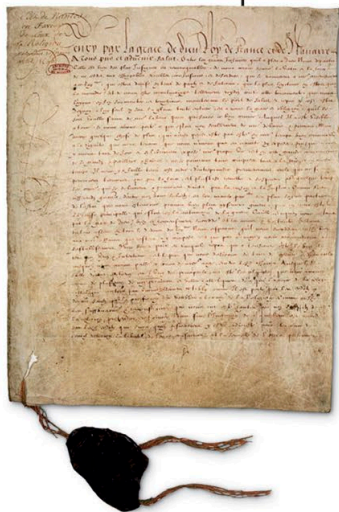
“All the world's a stage...”

SHAKESPEARE, AS YOU LIKE IT, 1599

1599

1591 At the Battle of Tondibi, the Moroccan army defeats the Songhai Empire in North Africa

△ Edict of Nantes, 1598



1594 GOOD KING HENRY

A Huguenot leader in France's Religious Wars, Henry of Navarre was crowned Henry IV of France in 1594. Seeking an end to religious conflict, he declared himself a Catholic while decreeing tolerance for Huguenots through the Edict of Nantes. Known as Good King Henry for his concern for his people's welfare, he was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1610.



△ Admiral Yi Sun-sin, bronze

1598 KOREA DEFEATS INVADERS

The effective ruler of all Japan, Toyotomi Hideyoshi, launched two seaborne invasions of Korea. Both failed thanks to the naval genius of Korean Admiral Yi Sun-sin. With a fleet that included “turtle ships” – cannon-armed metal-plated vessels – he repeatedly defeated the numerically superior Japanese. Yi died in November 1598 during the battle of Noryang, the final naval victory that ensured Korean independence.